need for help, have all along been treated in a step-motherly fashion.'[16] Sorabji had graduated from being merely the initiator of a bank to the status of a vocal advocate of banking as a means of economic development and ultimately improving the lot of the humblest citizen.

Sorabji once remarked: 'The Central Bank of India's progress and success is really the progress and success of Indian banking. The Central Bank is not the property of a few individuals and it has never been conducted for the benefit of a few persons. It is the property of the nation and it is our country's asset. Its success is the success of Indian Banking and we are only entrusted to steer it into safe waters. I and the staff of Central Bank always keep that end in view and we all strive to keep up and increase the prestige and good name of Indian banking.'[17]

Sorabji was concerned with the more general problem of cohesion in Indian banking by fostering relations between the provinces and the various banking institutions. It was with this in mind that he proposed a blueprint for federated banks in the Punjab and Bengal under which banking units in these provinces would function under independent boards and with their own management and capital structure. The scheme for the Punjab was almost ready by the end of 1936 and Sorabji visited Calcutta in May 1937 with a similar purpose in mind. In this he was assisted by J.C. Coyajee, then Professor of Economics at Calcutta University, who had been a member of the Hilton Young Commission on currency reform. However, Sorabji passed away soon after and the proposal remained a stillborn one.

An acknowledgement of Sorabji's banking expertise was his appointment as the Chairman of the Ceylon Banking Commission. Sorabji recommended a state-aided National Bank for Ceylon, supplemented by local banks in important places and gave detailed blueprints for their constitution and management.

Sorabji made a number of recommendations including licenses for both indigenous and foreign banks and provision for the investigation by the government into the affairs of a bank on a complaint by a depositor or a shareholder. One of his major recommendations was a statutory ceiling on rural interest rates and the creation of conciliatory boards in districts to bring about reconciliation between debtors and creditors in order to alleviate the burden of rural debt.